Rafael David José *Gameplay Developer*

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PROFILE

Gameplay Developer focused on building responsive and scalable game systems, from AI behaviors to UI/UX features. Currently pursuing an MSc in Artificial Intelligence for Games, working as a Teaching Assistant and Game Developer at HEI-Lab, combining technical expertise with a design-driven mindset. Experienced in multidisciplinary teams and collaborative development, with proficiency in C#, Python, and version control.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Game Developer 02/2026 – Present
HEI-Lab Lisbon, Portugal
Developing serious games and interactive applications, collaborating with multidisciplinary research teams on academic projects within the videogames field.

Teaching Assistant 09/2025 – Present
Lusófona University Lisbon, Portugal
- Teaching practical classes in Introduction to Computing and Programming Languages I for Videogames undergraduates, covering C#, Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), Python, version control with Git, Markdown, Mermaid, logic, and flowcharts.

Research Development Internship 03/2025 – 06/2025
Lusófona University Lisbon, Portugal
- Developed a real-time fire spread visualization system in Unity, focusing on performance optimization, GPU-based shaders, and terrain-driven progression to simulate wildfire behavior in large-scale environments.

Game Developer 09/2023 – 11/2025
ARR Studios Lisbon, Portugal
- Developed core gameplay and UI systems (inventory, crafting, enemy AI, menus, HUDs) in a university-led game studio, collaborating with a multidisciplinary team on multiple projects and playtesting sessions.

EDUCATION

Master's in Artificial Intelligence for Games 09/2025 – 07/2027
Lusófona University Lisbon
- **Scholarship:** *Merit Scholarship* (2025/2026, Lusófona University)

Bachelor's in Videogames 09/2023 – 07/2025
Lusófona University Lisbon
- **GPA:** 17/20 (Merit)
- **Scholarship:** *Municipal Merit Scholarship* (2024/2025, Câmara Municipal de Azambuja)
- **Scholarship:** *STEAM Merit Scholarship* (2023/2024, Lusófona University)

SELECTED PROJECTS

OuterDim 01/2025 – 07/2025
- Boss rush game inside a corrupted console. Geometric bosses shift phase by phase, changing gameplay and camera. (Unity, C#)

Magical Intern 09/2023 – 01/2024
- First-person puzzle game set in a wizard's workshop. Features custom inventory, object interaction, and environmental puzzles. (Unity, C#)

Company Roulette 01/2025 – 02/2025
- VR office encounter for Meta Quest with physics-based hand interaction, magazine-reload gunplay, and spatial audio. Built with XR Interaction Toolkit. (Unity 6, C#)

CyberBattle Online 05/2024 – 06/2024
- Multiplayer top-down shooter with score-based arenas. Implemented networking architecture with Unity Netcode for GameObjects and Unity Relay, including client-authoritative movement, scoring, respawn, and real-time leaderboard. (Unity, C#)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- C#
- Gameplay Programming
- Python
- Game Systems Design
- Object-Oriented Programming (OOP)
- AI Behaviors
- Version Control (Git)
- UI/UX Integration

HONORS & AWARDS

Best Student Game (OuterDim)
Code Exordium at Lisboa Games Week 2025

Public Choice (OuterDim)
Code Exordium at Lisboa Games Week 2025

Best Game 2025 (OuterDim)
Over & Out 2025

Best System Developed for a Game 2025 (OuterDim)
Over & Out 2025

The Special is 42 2024 (Magical Intern)
Over & Out 2024

Lusófona Games Collection 2024 (Magical Intern)
Lusófona University

Special 42 (Shadow Chase)
Over & Out 2023

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Speaking & Presentations
- *Guest Speaker*: Game Post-Mortem (Magical Intern) – Presented insights to students at Lusófona University
- *Media Feature*: RTP Arena – Game featured in a segment on Portuguese-made games

Workshops & Masterclasses (selected)
- *Masterclass*: Game-driven Inventions: A Creator's Journey - Robert J. Mical
- *Masterclass*: Quality Assurance in Game Development - Aleksander Kauch (11 bit Studios)
- *Masterclass*: Procedural Generation and Creative Facets of Games - Antonios Liapis
- *Masterclass*: Affective Game Computing - David Melhart
- *Masterclass*: Games and AI - Carlos Santos
- *Masterclass*: Artificial Intelligence in Games - Phil Lopes & Nuno Fachada
- Game Design Classics - Wilson Almeida
- Unity Fundamentals - Diogo Andrade
- Unreal Engine Workshop - Luís Monteiro

Industry Events
- Lisbon Games Week – Showcased games at Lusófona University stand

SELECTED CERTIFICATES

- Udemy - Make Online Games Using Unity's NEW Multiplayer Framework
- Udemy - Complete C# Unity Game Developer 3D
- Udemy - The Art of Doing: Video Game Creation With Python and Pygame

LANGUAGES

English — Fluent

Spanish — Conversational

Portuguese — Native/Bilingual

French — Basic